Loyola Marymount University
College of Business Administration

CBA Mission
Advance knowledge and develop business leaders with moral courage and creative confidence to be a force for good in the global community.

STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT

THIS SYLLABUS WILL BE CONTINUOUSLY UPDATED ON BRIGHTSPACE DURING THE TERM, PLEASE MAKE SURE TO KEEP YOURSELF UPDATED WITH ITS LATEST VERSION

Term/Semester	Spring 2026
Course Name:	Strategic Management
Course Number:	BCOR 4970
Credit Hours:	4
Instructor:	Esteban Marin
Email:	Esteban.Maringuillen@lmu.edu
LinkedIn:	linkedin.com/in/estebanmaring
Office Number:	
Office Hours:	By appointment via email
Office Phone:	
Class Time:	Thursday: 18:00 to 21:20
Classroom Location:	Hilton 063
Required Material:	Textbook: Frank T. Rothaermel. 2024. **Strategic Management**. 6th Edition. McGraw Hill Education (electronic or paper version).

Prerequisite(s)
BCOR 3410; BCOR 3510; BCOR 3610. Senior standing.

Course Description
This is a practical/applied course that develops strategic thinking skills that can empower managers to position their organizations to gain and sustain superior performance and competitive advantage. This course addresses strategy analysis, strategy formulation, and strategy implementation in the complex global economic and political environment we live in. The course requires students/participants to draw upon and integrate knowledge and skills developed throughout their business education. The approach taken in the course involves a combination of readings, case analyses, class discussions/contributions, and experiential learning.

Course Workload
This course is a four credits course. The standard for a 4-unit course requires an investment of a total of 180 hours of student/participant engagement with the course learning activities (at least 45 hours per credit). Students/participants should anticipate needing additional time outside of class to complete readings and assignments. I provide more on this subject under the Performance Evaluation and Grading section. You can find the University's Credit Unit Policy on this link: https://academics.lmu.edu/aprc/lmucredithourpolicy/

Course Learning Objectives
This course contributes to student/participant achievement of the following CBA core learning outcomes:

- Students/participants will be able to integrate core concepts and apply them to business situations.
- Students/participants will demonstrate critical thinking skills by defining, modeling, analyzing, and evaluating complex business problems.
- Students/participants will be able to analyze and evaluate companies within their industries based on their unique value proposition/competitive advantages including but not limited to:
    - Students/participants will be able to analyze the internal and external environment of organizations.
    - Students/participants will be able to evaluate functional, business, corporate, and global strategies.
    - Students/participants will demonstrate effective interpersonal skills in teamwork settings.
    - Students will communicate on business topics both in written and oral form.
    - Students/participants will understand how changes in the business environment affect strategic direction and business operations in an organization.

Course Learning Outcomes
Upon completion of this course, students/participants should successfully meet the following strategic management course learning outcomes:

- To develop an appreciation of the type, variety, and magnitude of factors that must be considered and decisions that must be made by the senior managers of an organization in a complex society.
- To develop the ability to engage in "strategic thinking" to examine alternative courses of action to select the "best fit" strategy, and to defend selected strategic decisions.
- To have exposure to the tasks and challenges involved in organizing and controlling a complex organization so that it may pursue its strategic objectives.
- To integrate previously acquired analytic tools and viewpoints of specific functional disciplines as a means of making decisions and developing organizational plans.
- To understand functional, business, and corporate strategies in domestic and international markets in a wide variety of industry contexts, and how executives plan and implement these strategies.
- To learn to deal with the uncertainty and ambiguity that surrounds the processes of strategic management through a variety of classroom experiences.

Instructional Methodology
Discussions/contributions, individual case analyses, team/group case analyses, lectures, and/or team/group strategy experiential activities/exercises/games, etc.
Materials will be posted on Brightspace.

Performance Evaluation and Grading

The purpose of evaluation in this course is manifold. Each of the evaluation mechanisms serves a formative purpose – that is, it provides feedback to help improve learning and ultimately strategic management thinking and skills. In addition, the evaluations serve a motivational purpose. They highlight what is considered important in terms of the learning objectives of the course, and they direct attention to these elements. Finally, they provide a basis for assigning grades. Assigning grades is a necessary element of most university teaching courses and represents a significant part of an instructor's responsibilities.

The specific points of evaluation, and their associated weights for grading, are as follows:

Performance Evaluation and Grading	
Evaluation Element	**Weight (%)**
Class Contribution (Individual grade)	15
Case 1 (Group grade)	15
Case 2 (Group grade)	15
Case 3 (Group grade)	15
Midterm Exam (Individual grade)	20
Final Exam (Individual grade)	20
Total	100

Note 1 (Extra Credit Work): With the preapproval of the instructor, students/participants who want to improve their course grade can prepare a research paper (maximum 5 pages single spaced including everything) &/or presentation (maximum 5 slides presented within 5 minutes) on a current business news/company related to one of the chapters that are discussed in this course; the paper &/or presentation should be submitted as Word &/or PPT, not as PDF.

The research paper/presentation should be the participant's/student's ***original*** individual work (not group work) and should be submitted/presented during one of the sessions when this chapter is being discussed in class.

Each student must request this extra credit work 2 weeks prior of the chapter discussion.

Participants/students will get bonus grades on the entire course grade based on how 1) current, 2) interesting, 3) relevant to the chosen book chapter, 4) well-researched, 5) well-written/well-presented, and 6) well-referenced their research paper &/or presentation is/are.

Note 2 (Class Contribution): To be able to better contribute to the class discussions, you are expected to read the assigned readings/chapters before we discuss them in class.

Note 3 (Performance Evals): The evaluation elements and weights are subject to change.

Final course grades will be assigned as follows:		
A: 93 – 100%	A^-: 90 – 92%	
B^+: 87 – 89%	B: 83 – 86%	B^-: 80 – 82%
C^+: 77 – 79%	C 73 – 76%	C^-: 70 – 72%
D: 60 – 69%	F: 0 – 59%	

The following sections outline the elements of evaluation in greater detail, with explanations of their purpose and specific requirements.

Class Contribution
One major requirement to become successful is the value-added you bring. We will apply this rule in class before you go out to the real world. To add value, one needs to be prepared. I expect you to read and think critically about all readings/chapters for each specific session. Sessions will take the form of discussions of main ideas/concepts rather than the form of lecturing given this course is offered at a relatively senior level and that it integrates knowledge you have acquired in other courses.
To have a good grade on class contribution you need to read the assigned readings/chapters before we discuss them in class. Your contribution grade depends on the ***quantity*** of your interventions as well as on the ***quality*** of your contributions.

Attendance
Though not graded, attendance is mandatory. It has a direct and strong relationship to the contribution grade. You cannot contribute if you are not in class.
Please inform me early on in case you are unable to attend a given lecture and provide a valid justification. All prevailing or updated LMU attendance (and absence) rules and regulations will apply.

Cases
Cases will be assigned that describe situations. Students/participants will be asked to analyze these cases, answer the case questions on how to manage these situations as Strategic Management experts and submit written analyses electronically.

Cases are generally expected to be analyzed in teams/groups. Creativity in proposing avenues to solve the cases is welcome, but relevant consequences cannot be ignored.

Cases will be graded based on how well any recommended courses of action are justified and, on the ability, to foresee the impact of these recommendations as well as the final decisions/choices/courses of action.

Grading
Questions 50%
Analysis and justification 30%
Additional support and learning extension 20%

Midterm and Final Exams

The midterm and final exams will be done in class on your laptops, so please ensure that you will be able to have access to a laptop on the midterm and final exam dates. The exams may include multiple-choice questions (MCQs), essay questions, mini case questions, or any combination of the above.

Only in cases of extreme emergencies (i.e., death in the family, surgery, serious illness, force majeure …), you or your designated representative must inform me before the exam time and submit the following documents within 24 hours from the missed exam time:

a. Makeup petition request.
b. Medical or hospital reports officially signed.

If the petition is approved, the student/participant must be prepared to sit for a makeup exam or be evaluated in alternative ways by the current semester's final exam period at the latest so grades can be submitted on time.
Otherwise, the student will get a zero on their exam.

Course Outline
Note 1: The course outline is subject to change.
Note 2: To be able to better contribute to the class discussions, please read the material that will be covered in each session before coming to class.

Weeks / Dates	**Topics, Assignments, etc.**
1 / Jan 15 (Classes begin)	**Welcome & Intro to the Course** *Syllabus discussion **Ch 1: What Is Strategy?** Ch 1 Group Experiential Learning Activity/Exercise/Game
2 / Jan 22	**Ch 2: Strategic Leadership: Managing the Strategy Process** *Finalize case teams *Introduction to case analysis (Tentative) Ch 2 Group Experiential Learning Activity/Exercise/Game (Tentative)
3 / Jan 29	**Ch 3: External Analysis: Industry Structure, Competitive Forces, and Strategic Groups** *Assign Case 1 *First class available for extra credit
4 / Feb 5	**Ch 3: External Analysis: Industry Structure, Competitive Forces, and Strategic Groups** Ch 3 Group Experiential Learning Activity/Exercise/Game (Tentative)
5 / Feb 12	**Ch 4: Internal Analysis: Resources, Capabilities, and Core Competencies**
6 / Feb 19	**Ch 5: Shared Value and Competitive Advantage** **Midterm Recap**
7 / Feb 26	**Midterm Exam: During Class Time (Ch 1, 2, 3, 4, 5)** **Exam will be on computer, please make sure to bring your laptops with you to class with fully charged batteries that can last for more than the exam's duration.*
8 / Mar 5	**Spring Break!!**

9 / Mar 12	**Ch 6: Business Strategy: Differentiation, Cost Leadership, and Blue Oceans** Ch 5 Group Experiential Learning Activity/Exercise/Game (Tentative) *Assign Case 2
10 / Mar 19	**Ch 8: Corporate Strategy: Vertical Integration and Diversification**
11 / Mar 26	**Ch 10: Global Strategy: Competing Around the World**
12 / April 2	**Easter week**
13 / April 9	**Ch 11: Organizational Design: Structure, Culture, & Control** Ch 11 Group Experiential Learning Activity/Exercise/Game (Tentative) *Assign Case 3
14 / April 16	**Ch 12: Corporate Governance, Business Ethics, and Business Models**
15 / April 23	*Teaching Evaluations *Final exam recap
17 / May 7	**Final Exam: (Ch 6, 8, 10, 11, 12)** **Final exam will be on computer, please make sure to bring your laptops with you to class with fully charged batteries that can last for more than the exam's duration.*

Students with Special Needs or Disabilities
Americans with Disabilities Act: Students with special needs as addressed by the Americans with Disabilities Act who need reasonable modifications, special assistance, or accommodations in this course should promptly direct their request to the Disability Support Services (DSS) Office. Any student who currently has a documented disability (physical, sensory, learning, or psychological) needing academic accommodations should contact the Disability Support Services (DSS) Office (Daum Hall Room 224, 310-338-4535, www.lmu.edu/dss) as early in the semester as possible. All discussions will remain confidential.

Use of Technology
Students will be expected to use MS Office as well as Zoom, MS Teams, Web browsing (e.g., Chrome), Brightspace, Turnitin, and other relevant technologies.

Academic Honesty
Academic dishonesty will be treated as an extremely serious matter, with consequences that can range from receiving no credit for assignments/tests to expulsion. It is never permissible to turn in any work that has been copied from another student or copied from a source (including the Internet) without properly acknowledging the source. It is your responsibility to make sure that your work meets the standard of academic honesty set forth in the "LMU Academic Degree Requirements and Policies", which appears in the LMU Bulletin 2025 – 2026 Edition: https://bulletin.lmu.edu/academic-degree-requirements-policies/#text.

Course Policies

Attendance: Attendance in this course is required. Students should arrive on time to all course meetings, prepared to engage in the course content. Arriving late or leaving early disrupts the learning experience.

Deadlines: Written assignments should be uploaded on Brightspace on or prior to the due date. If you have an emergency or other extenuating circumstances and need to turn in an assignment later than its due date, you must contact me before the assignment is due (by email).

Please note that late submissions will automatically lose one point over hundred per every late hour (i.e. a submission that is 10 hours late will lose 10 points over 100, a submission that is 1 day late will lose 24 points over 100, etc.). Missing work will be assigned a grade of zero.

Teamwork: I will randomly form teams of students to work on cases. Individuals must contribute their fair share to any team effort resulting in a deliverable to the instructor.

Missed Exams: Students who do not sit for the midterm exam will be assigned a grade of zero. The only acceptable excuses for missing an examination are a personal medical emergency or a death in the immediate family. (Documentation will be required). In this case, a makeup exam may be administered. If you have a valid emergency and cannot attend an exam, please notify me as early as possible.

Expectations for Classroom Behavior: Students are encouraged to engage respectfully with each other. There are several documents describing expectations for student conduct and behavior at LMU. Please review the documents listed below.
• The Lion's Code:
https://studentaffairs.lmu.edu/about/studentaffairsdeansoffice/lionscode/
• The LMU Student Conduct Code:
https://studentaffairs.lmu.edu/about/osccr/studentcodespolicies/
• Additional guidelines on LMU Student Classroom and Course-Related Behavior:
https://lmu.box.com/s/v2x89uspgbx3l23egcz7mjd6dbekcn60
• Students are required to adhere to the behavior standards listed in the Loyola Marymount University Community Standards and to refrain from disrupting classes and other academic settings. The LMU Community Standards document:
https://studentaffairs.lmu.edu/about/studentaffairsdeansoffice/lionscode/communitystandardsprocess/

RESPECT FOR SELF AND OTHERS: As an LMU Lion, by the Lion's Code, you pledged to join the discourse of the academy with honesty of voice and integrity of scholarship and to show respect for staff, professors, and other students.

Thank you for your cooperation and enjoy the class! 😊